MAGI

DESIGN FILE · INTERFACE & INTERACTION SPECIFICATION · VERSION 0.1

1. Design direction

Core philosophy: The best design is barely noticed. Magi should feel minimal, quiet, and functional. The effects—not the interface—should hold the user's attention.

- Visual language: minimalist, black and white, restrained, and editorial.
- Reference point: Maison Margiela-inspired minimalism as a design philosophy; do not copy its logo, branding, or proprietary assets.
- Typography starting point: Inter, preferably regular or light weights. Treat this as a recommendation that can change after visual testing.
- Use generous spacing and avoid unnecessary decoration, labels, and interface noise.

2. Canvas and responsive behavior

The canvas is the area where the live camera, uploaded media, and effect preview appear. Magi is desktop-first but must also work on mobile. Do not force every screen into a phone-shaped 9:16 frame.

- Desktop: use a flexible preview area that fits the available window while preserving the source media's aspect ratio.
- Mobile: adapt the preview and controls to the narrower viewport.
- Avoid stretching or distorting the source image/video. Fit or crop intentionally and consistently.
- A layout grid may be used internally to align interface elements. Keep grid lines hidden in the user-facing experience unless a future design decision calls for them.

3. Main camera screen

- Open directly to a clean live-camera view when camera permission is available.
- Place a small inverse-color M wordmark in the top-left corner. Inverse means it contrasts with the content beneath it.
- Do not show additional text labels on the main camera screen.
- Keep the preview visually dominant and controls unobtrusive.

4. Bottom toolbar

Use a fixed bottom toolbar with simple icon-based controls and no text labels.

- **Left/primary mode control:** a quick Photo / Video toggle, inspired by the straightforward mode selector in Apple Photo Booth.
- **Center:** one prominent capture button. In Photo mode it captures a still image; in Video mode it starts and stops recording with separate clicks/taps. The user should not need to hold the button.
- **Bottom-right:** the effects-tray caret control.

5. Effects tray

- The tray is closed by default.

- Open it by clicking/tapping a minimal upward-pointing caret at the bottom-right.
- Use a subtle opening animation.
- On desktop hover, the caret may show a slight white glow; keep the glow restrained.
- Display effect names as text inside clean rectangular tiles.
- All effect tiles must have the same dimensions and visual treatment.
- Use text only—no thumbnails or preview images in the initial version.

Initial effect order

- Bitmap — first release
- ASI Symbols
- Binary
- X's and O's

Only Bitmap is required for the first release. The other three are planned effects.

6. Shared effect controls

Use a consistent control pattern across effects where it makes sense. Do not force a parameter onto an effect if it does not need it. Keep the system flexible as effects are prototyped.

- **Scale:** adjusts the size of the visual elements. Use the label “Scale.”
- **Intensity:** adjusts how strongly the effect is expressed.
- **Depth:** a planned shared parameter where relevant; it refers to generalized camera-aware distance, not face or hand tracking.
- **Reset:** provide a reset-to-defaults action in a consistent location across effects.

7. Bitmap control and visual specification

- Visual elements: square pixels.
- Palette: pure black and pure white only; do not render gray pixels.
- Tonal illusion: the distribution and density of black and white pixels create the appearance of gray.
- Classic bitmap behavior: darker source regions have denser black coverage; lighter regions have sparser black coverage.
- Depth: respond to generalized depth in the camera scene. Do not implement face tracking or hand tracking for the initial version.
- Motion: gentle and simple by default.
- Controls: Scale and Intensity; Scale defaults to medium. Include reset.

8. Capture, review, and save states

After a photo is captured or a video recording is stopped, freeze the preview so the user can review the result.

- The central capture button becomes the retake action.
- Show a save-to-device action in the top-right corner.
- Use a small download-icon animation as feedback when saving.

- Do not add drawing, stickers, text overlays, or social-sharing tools in the initial scope.
- The primary output is saving the processed photo or video to the user's device/camera roll.

9. Interaction states to design

- Default live camera screen.
- Camera permission not yet granted or denied.
- Effects tray closed and open.
- Each effect selected and active.
- Effect controls being adjusted.
- Photo mode ready and photo captured/reviewing.
- Video mode ready, recording, and stopped/reviewing.
- Save in progress and save complete.
- Uploaded photo/video selected and previewing.

10. Accessibility and usability notes

- Keep controls large enough to click or tap reliably.
- Provide accessible names for icon-only controls even though visible text labels are omitted.
- Do not rely on hover alone; all essential actions must work with touch and keyboard.
- Maintain clear focus states and sufficient contrast in the monochrome interface.
- Respect browser camera and microphone permission states; explain permission needs plainly when required.

11. Open design decisions

- Exact toolbar dimensions, spacing, and icon geometry.
- Whether Photo / Video is a segmented toggle or another compact selector.
- Exact canvas fitting behavior for portrait, landscape, and square media.
- Exact control layout and visual treatment for Scale, Intensity, and Depth.
- How generalized depth should influence Bitmap after technical prototypes are tested.
- Whether the effects tray should become a persistent side panel on wide desktop screens.

Status: Working design specification. Use it as a starting point for wireframes and prototypes; revise decisions when testing reveals a better solution.